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COMMUNITY CORNER PARSHAS TAZRIA-METZORA תזריע-מצורא

SHABBOSS STARTS: 7:20 PM (18 MINUTES)
SHABBOSS ENDS: 8:29 PM (50 MINUTES)
TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM: 8:50 PM (72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern

Made possible by contributing writers throughout our community.

STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz



Reb Leib Sarah's, one of the greatest of the Baal Shem Tov's disciples, had lived in the Holy Land. After years of struggle, of wandering, of perfecting himself to the utmost of his ability, his deepest wish was to settle in the Holy Land, to be able to achieve spiritual achievements unreachable elsewhere.

Although he was a person of renown, he was also a student of the Baal Shem Tov. Thus, he travelled to the Baal Shem Tov in Medzibozh. "Rebbe," he asked, "I request your permission and blessing to settle in the Holy Land, which is my heart's desire." But, to his surprise, the Baal Shem Tov's reply was negative. The next year Leib Sarah's again went to his Rebbe in Medzibozh with the same petition. But, again, the Baal Shem Tov denied his request, without even an explanation. This scenario repeated itself year after year for several years, and Leib Sarah's was deeply disappointed.

One year, the desire to move to the Holy Land had become so strong within him that he could no longer deny it. So, Leib Sarah's sat down with his wife and then with his children and discussed the question of moving to the Holy Land to perfect his soul in the service of his Maker. His wife and children were all agreeable, and so it was decided to go. Wasting no time, he sold all of his worldly goods save the barest necessities, and gathering all of his money, he bought tickets for his family for the long journey to the Land of Israel.

When everything was in order, Reb Leib Sarah's set off with his family through Russia toward Turkey, whence he would travel to Israel. It was a slow and arduous journey overland with many stops in the small towns and villages through which they had to travel. One day they came to a small town and noticed some sort of excitement in the town. Leib Sarah's inquired of the villagers and was shocked when he heard their reply. For none other than the famous Baal Shem Tov was unexpectedly visiting the town, and the people were overwhelmed by the great honor of receiving such a personage.

Leib Sarah's was even more overwhelmed by his own dilemma. He thought of the possibility of not going to greet his Rebbe, thereby avoiding any embarrassment that he was traveling without his Rebbe's blessing, but how could he not acknowledge the presence of his great teacher? He sat in his wagon deliberating, when suddenly he had no choice, for the Baal Shem Tov's carriage pulled up next to his own. Reb Leib Sarah's dismounted and approached the Rebbe. The Baal Shem Tov appeared to be surprised and asked, "What are you doing here?"

"Rebbe, please forgive me for not heeding your words, but I am now on my way to settle in the Holy Land."

The Baal Shem Tov replied, "Well, if your wish to go is so strong, then go. But now, where are you going to spend Shabbat?"

"I am just now searching for a place, but it's difficult since I spent all of my money on the tickets for the journey," replied Reb Leib. The Baal Shem Tov offered to host Reb Leib and his family for the whole Shabbat. When they were in their rooms preparing for the arrival of the holy day, the Baal Shem Tov knocked on Reb Leib's door, asking if he had immersed in the mikva yet. "No," he replied, "I have no money remaining, so I will forego the mikva this week." To this, the Baal Shem Tov replied that he would pay the entrance fee for him. Reb Leib Sarah's joy was unbounded, for he understood the profound meaning of the immersion and was relieved not to miss his usual ritual.

Upon arriving at the mikva the Baal Shem Tov said, "Reb Leib, you go first." But, he refused, saying, "Please, Rebbe, you go; you are my teacher, after all."

The Baal Shem Tov was adamant, and Reb Leib immersed first. After the prescribed immersions were completed, he rose from the water, turned to the Baal Shem Tov and said, "I have changed my mind. I will not go to the Holy Land. I will return to Medzibozh, to you."

"Let me tell you what I saw in the mikva during my immersions. As I entered the water I saw a continent. As I looked closely, I saw the Land of Israel, and as I looked even more closely I saw Jerusalem. As I narrowed my focus still more, I could see all the parts of the Temple Mount, even the Holy Temple itself. Then I looked inside and saw the Holy of Holies. But though I strained my eyes as hard as I could, I couldn't see the Holy Ark, the Tablets of the Law, or the Divine Presence."

"In my anguish I cried out, 'Where are the Tablets? Where is the Divine Presence?'"

"A Heavenly Voice answered me, saying, 'They are found in Medzibozh.'"

Therefore, I am following you back to Medzibozh to fulfill my Divine Service. I now see that during the exile, the Divine Presence dwells with the leader of the generation."

LOOK OUT FOR NEXT WEEK'S ISSUE!
A SPECIAL INTERVIEW WITH MEANINGFUL MINUTE'S NACHI GORDON!



COMMUNITY CORNER
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PARSHA QUESTION By: Gavriel Grodco

Because of my chatter, I bring birds that chatter. Who am I?

Stay tuned for the answer in the next Community Corner issue

Answer to Pesach Edition Question:
Q. Where lies the difference between the question of the chuchum and the question of the rasha?
A. The chuchum is asking and looking to understand and the rasha is telling and looking for an excuse to rebel.

MEGA VORT By: Yoel Megadesh



Parshas Tazria. Perek 13. Pasuk 33
This pasuk talks about the metzora having to shave all his hair at the end of his purification process. The word haircut (ותגלח) has a big ג in the Torah. Why?
1) One answer is that this commandment pushes off 3 (ג) sins. The sin of shaving off ALL your hair including payos, the extra sin if he is a Kohen and the extra sin if he is a nazir. (Meshech Chochma)
2) Another answer is that 3 people have to shave off ALL their hair. A metzora, a nazir, and the Leviim when they were inaugurated. (Bal Haturim)

Parshas Metzora. Perek 14. Pasuk 32
This pasuk talks about which korbanos a poor metzora has to bring as opposed to a rich metzora for their purification process. The question is, why this pasuk is introduced with the words "זאת תורת" which means "this is the rule ...for a poor metzora" as if it is the norm for a metzora to be poor. It does not say "this is the rule...if he is rich". Why would it be more normal for the metzora to be poor? It says in the medrash that Hashem does not punish the person himself first. Hashem will first bring tzaraas on his house and then his clothing. If the person still doesn't get it, Hashem will bring tzaraas on the person himself. So by the time he gets it on himself, he will have lost his house and clothing and will then be poor and have to usually bring the poor metzora's korban. (Rabbi Shimon Schwab)

NOACH'S JOKES & RIDDLES By: Noach Isaacs



How do you cut an ocean in half?
ANSWER: WITH A SEA-SAW

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That potential is born and is now a reality waiting to develop!



Wisconsin



Ask ^{Dr.}Hirsch Weekly Q&A with Dr. Shari Hirsch,
Pediatrician and Lactation Specialist at Lev Pediatric Care

Send it to Lev Pediatric Care, and Dr. Hirsch may feature it in an upcoming Q and A.

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A	H	D	S	I	A	S	H	O	A	A	E	N	R

Play this puzzle online at : <https://thewordsearch.com/puzzle/9597032/>

A map of Pomona, California, with several locations marked as 'COMMUNITY CORNER'. The markers are purple pentagons with white text. The locations are: 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (top left), 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (top center), 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (top right), 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (middle left), 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (middle center), 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (middle right), 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (bottom left), 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (bottom center), and 'COMMUNITY CORNER' (bottom right). The map shows major roads like Highway 10, Highway 60, and Highway 78, as well as landmarks like the Pomona Fairgrounds and the Pomona Race Track. The map is titled 'POMONA' in large, bold, white letters on a blue background.

A map of the Wesley Hills area with three 'COMMUNITY CORNER' locations highlighted. The locations are marked with purple and blue icons. The first icon is at the intersection of 1400 S. and 1400 E. The second icon is at the intersection of 1400 S. and 1400 E. The third icon is at the intersection of 1400 S. and 1400 E.

The Shul of Pomona Heights, 60 Halley drive (Mickey Schlusser)
Anshel Palisades, 11 Palisades Court, Pomona (Shalom Yoblonsky)
Ohr Yavook Shalom, 43 Tamarrac Lane, Pomona (Yakov Rosenthal)
Kehal Avreichim Pomona, 3 Chestnut Drive, Pomona (Avi Hirsch)
9 Ladentown Road, Pomona (Berry Nash)
15 Woodfield Rd, Pomona (Doni Stern)
34 N Ridge Rd, Pomona (Shaya Setton)
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56 mayer Dr Montebello (Shmuel Gancz)
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Atreses Rosh 16 Charlotte Drive (Avi Stern)
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